

## IT IS WRITTEN

**TEXT:** Matthew 4:1-11 (NKJV) *“Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil. <sup>2</sup> And when He had fasted forty days and forty nights, afterward He was hungry. <sup>3</sup> Now when the tempter came to Him, he said, ‘If You are the Son of God, command that these stones become bread.’” <sup>4</sup> But He answered and said, ‘It is written, ‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God.’” <sup>5</sup> Then the devil took Him up into the holy city, set Him on the pinnacle of the temple, <sup>6</sup> and said to Him, ‘If You are the Son of God, throw Yourself down. For it is written: ‘He shall give His angels charge over you,’ and, ‘In their hands they shall bear you up, Lest you dash your foot against a stone.’” <sup>7</sup> Jesus said to him, ‘It is written again, ‘You shall not tempt the LORD your God.’” <sup>8</sup> Again, the devil took Him up on an exceedingly high mountain, and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and*

*their glory. <sup>9</sup> And he said to Him, “All these things I will give You if You will fall down and worship me.” <sup>10</sup> Then Jesus said to him, “Away with you, Satan! For it is written, ‘You shall worship the LORD your God, and Him only you shall serve.’” <sup>11</sup> Then the devil left Him, and behold, angels came and ministered to Him.”*

**INTRO:** The story of the temptation of Jesus seems to have a strange setting indeed. A baptismal service was being conducted in the Jordan River and John the Baptist was the name of the minister performing the ordinance of water baptism.

Immediately following the baptism of one of the candidates John looked up to see a young man approaching from the distant horizon. As the man drew nearer John recognized the familiar stride of his cousin, Jesus Christ. In his attempt to exchange pleasantries with Jesus, John utters words that would become an historic anomaly

and a prophetic benchmark; "***Behold the lamb of God which taketh away the sins of the world.***"

Everyone in the crowd caught and held their breath; exchanged glances of wonder; and were apparently shocked at the bold statement of this wilderness preacher. John was certainly not one who made a habit of mincing words or beating around the bush but this was an uncharacteristically bold statement, even for John.

Every Jewish person gathered in this small group of converts was very well rehearsed with regard to the work of the sacrificial lamb on the Day of Atonement. In his declaration of his Cousin Jesus' arrival, John not only declared Jesus to be a lamb but "***THE Lamb of God***" that would "***TAKE AWAY the sins of the world.***" John was declaring that Jesus would attain a threshold of achievement that no other lamb for centuries past had been able to attain,

though they had given their very lives. The work of the lamb that John was speaking of would be to forgive sin - not just roll them ahead a year at a time. For all practical purposes John declared Jesus to be the Messiah!

Upon His baptism, a wonderful phenomenon occurred involving a dove, defying its nature to make physical contact with a human being, and a voice booming from the sky saying "***This is my beloved son in whom I am well pleased.***"

The really shocking feature of this entire story is what happens next: Jesus is "***Led of the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.***"

Three times Jesus is "***Tempted by the devil***" and three times He resists the temptation the same way. He puts up His resistance by saying, "***It is written.***"

One commentaries makes this statement regarding Jesus' resistance of the enemy: "***By relying on the power and truth of God's Word,***

*Jesus was willing to fight this battle as a man. He could have easily rebuked Satan into another galaxy, but resisted him in a way that WE CAN IMITATE and IDENTIFY with.”*

*Charles Spurgeon states: “Jesus used Scripture to battle Satan’s temptation, not some elaborate spiritual power inaccessible to us. Jesus fought this battle as fully man, and He drew on no special resources unavailable to us. Out flashed the sword of the Spirit: Our Lord would choose to fight with no other weapon. He could have spoken new revelations, but chose to say, ‘It is written’”.*

*Bro. Haskel Grant used to tell me, “I like it when you give the devil verbal abuse.”*

When we resist the Devil we must do so in the same way Jesus did, by saying, ***“It is written.”***

Today I want to give you ten scriptures you can use to give the devil a nervous breakdown:

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Luke 10:19: “*Behold, I give you the authority to trample on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy, and nothing shall by any means hurt you.*” Satan hates this Scripture because of its assurance that nothing is to be feared when advancing against the enemy. We should use this verse to enforce our authority over Satan.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Romans 8:1: “*There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus, who do not walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit.*” Satan hates this Scripture because it liberates God’s people from false self-condemnation. As forgiven Christians we can throw Romans 8:1 right back into Satan’s face to silence his accusations.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Philippians 2:9,10: “*Therefore God has highly exalted Him and given Him the name which is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee*

*shall bow, of those in heaven, and of those on earth, and of those under the earth.”* Satan hates this Scripture because it explains how effectively Christians can enforce the authority invested in the name of Jesus.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in 1 John 3:8: *“He who sins is of the devil, for the devil has sinned from the beginning. For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that He might destroy the works of the devil.”* We should use this verse to remind the devil that his power over us has been shattered!

**IT IS WRITTEN** in James 4:7: *“Therefore submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you.”* We should use this verse to demand that Satan leave us alone.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Hebrews 4:12: *“For the Word of God is living and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword, piercing even to the division of soul and spirit, and of*

*joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.”* Satan hates this Scripture because it shows the Word is an offensive weapon for us to use to defeat him in every attack. Did you realize that in the armor list in Ephesians 6, that the sword of the Spirit and the shield of faith are the only weapons we wield? All other parts of the armor are passive, these two weapons are active!

**IT IS WRITTEN** in John 8:32: “*And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.*” Satan hates this Scripture because the last thing he wants us to experience is freedom from his lies, guilt and condemnation!

**IT IS WRITTEN** in John 16:13: “*However, when He, the Spirit of truth, has come He will guide you into all truth; for He will not speak on His own authority, but whatever He hears He will speak; and He will tell you things to come.*” The presence of the Holy Spirit in our lives empowers us with wisdom, truth, and

divine direction. All these things are direct opposites to what the enemy wants us to know.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Isaiah 14:12: “*How you are fallen from heaven, O Lucifer, son on the morning! How you are cut down to the ground. You who weakened the nations!*”

When Satan reminds us of our past, there’s something in our future he does not want us to see. Remind him of his past, present and future.

**IT IS WRITTEN** in Ephesians 6:11: “*Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.*”

When we put on the full armor of God, we are telling the devil that he has to go through Jesus to get to us.

Let’s declare “***IT IS WRITTEN***” over our situation today, and silence the enemy!